

This adventure is a variant of the "Gnomengarde Quest" from DnD 5e Essentials Kit.

1 Background

Mr Masonport and his investors have started setting up factories in Embergate to supply the growing city. To undercut the competition early they've pulled prices as far down as possible, they've made it possible through lowering their workers wages and safety. The employies are mainly rock gnomes from poorer parts of the old world who rely on the company to survive. Too afraid from going to the guard due to potential corruption most workers try to keep their heads down.

A few months ago a group of gnomes managed to sneak out and run away from the city to escape Mr Masonport. They made it to the foot of a mountain with the ability to sustain them. Since then they've grown their numbers and have been sustaining themselves by stealing from material caravans to craft nicknacks which they then sneak into town to sell. Recently the group have grown a bit bolder and have been sabotaging the factories in an attempt to drive Masonport n Co out of Embergate.

Mr Masonport have sent a missive to Marlows guild to stop the thieves for good.

2 Quest board

Quest Giver: Mr Grindley Masonport

Quest: Mr Masonport of "Masonport n Co" have had reports of their machines being clogged up with shoes and their inventory stolen by a gang of criminals . They've found tracks leading outside of town to where they must hide. Have them punished and the arcane products returned as proof.

Reward: A "Masonport n Co" branded magic item & 15 gold pieces for each proof of punishment

3 Details

Since the difficulty of the quest is between level 1 & 2 the XP, Treasure & magic items to be rewarded should be:

150-200 xp

75-125 gp per player.

1 permanent magic item worth less than 400gp & two consumables worth less than 200gp

In both scenarios there are a mystery key & a potion of Polychromy hidden in the material heap.

3.1 Route: Company Muscle

The players can go into the workers camp and deal with them through violence, this would satesfy Mr Masonport. If they bring back proof of such acts he will pay them up to 300gp for a total of 20 pieces of proof.

If the players ensure no further actions against the company is done but without any proof he will pay them 150gp at most.

He will present a choice between a Hat of wizardy and a wand of pyrotechnics. Both of which have noticable branding on each.

This more combat heavy and harder encounter will reward the players with 200 xp each.

3.2 Route: Workers Rights

The players can go and parley with the workers finding their cause worthwhile they can help their internal struggle.

If the struggle is resolved the gnomes offer up the coice of a Hat of wizardy and a wand of pyrotechnics and if the players lies about the location or nature to Mr Masonport the gnomes will pay the players when they have the means to.

The payment will be 125 gp per player sent through a box contraption which break upon opening.

This more conversation heavy encountet will reward the players 150 xp each.